

Role Guide 1: PI / System Admin

Step-by-step instructions for the PI / System Admin role in the ABF-FST Digital Respondent Portal.

STUDY	Developing and Validating the Agribusiness Bankability Framework for Food Systems Transformation through Novel Financing Models in Zimbabwe (ABF-FST)
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VERSION	Version 1.0 · 15 September 2026

Screenshots in this document use ***fictional demonstration data***. Organisation and person names, phone numbers and figures shown in them are not real study records.

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1. Your role at a glance

As PI you own the study and the system. You see every screen, approve how fieldwork runs, create accounts, decide replacements and withdrawals, review the audit trail, and are the only person who can download the full operational data and the complete KoboToolbox data for cleaning and analysis.

You can

- Open all 19 screens, including the Audit Log and every export.
- Create, change and deactivate staff accounts and roles.
- Do everything the Field Coordinator can: register organisations, assign Contact RAs, verify cases in bulk, invite, activate Reserves, record withdrawals, take QA decisions, manage KII and document records, log costs.
- Download the full operational export, and each KoboToolbox form as an Excel workbook and a PDF ZIP.
- Manage the KoboToolbox forms and the connection to them.

You cannot

- Change a Sample ID or Master ID, or move a case through statuses the rules do not allow — nobody can.
- Pass a questionnaire QA without writing a note.
- Invite a locked Reserve.

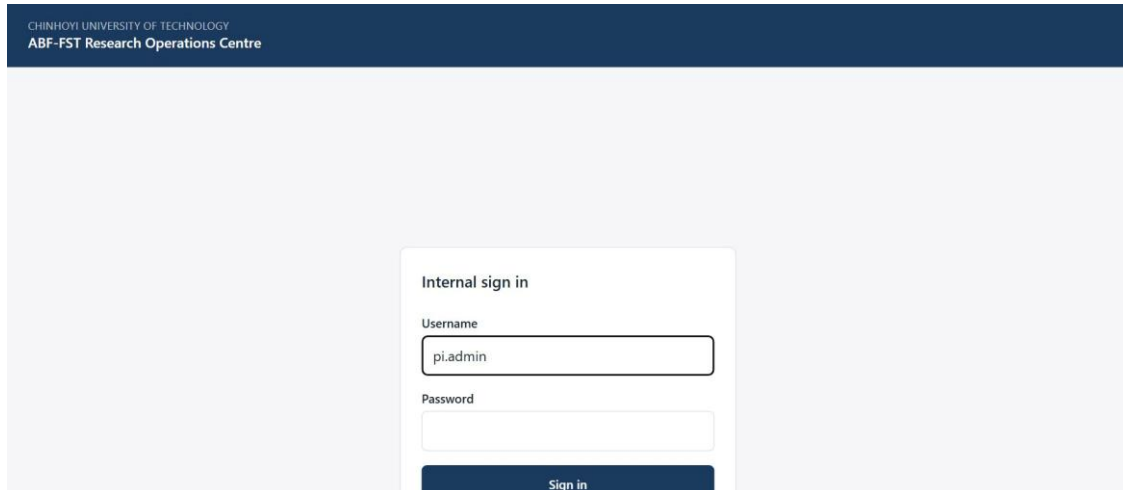
Where this fits

The System Manual explains how the whole system works. This guide covers only what you do. Ask the Field Coordinator or PI when something is outside your role.

2. Signing in and your screens

Signing in

1. Open <https://research.agribizframework.com/admin/login> in any modern browser (Chrome, Edge, Firefox or Safari), on a computer, tablet or phone.
2. Type your **Username** and **Password**, then select **Sign in**.



CHINHOMY UNIVERSITY OF TECHNOLOGY
ABF-FST Research Operations Centre

Internal sign in

Username
pi.admin

Password

Sign in

Figure 1. The sign-in screen for all internal staff.

3. You arrive on your start screen: **Executive Dashboard**. The bar across the top lists only the screens your role (PI / System Admin) can open.

Accounts

There is no self-registration. The PI / System Admin creates every account and sets its role. Ask the PI if you need an account, a different role, or a password reset.

Finding your way around

- The **top bar** shows your username and role, and the screens you can use. It is not a full menu with some items greyed out: anything absent is simply not part of your role.
- Most screens have a **← Back to ...** link at the top that returns you to the screen you came from.
- Registers show **20 rows per page**. Use **Previous** and **Next** at the foot of the list, and the **Search** box above it.
- **Change password** (top right) lets you set a new password at any time. Choose a long password you do not use anywhere else.
- **Sign out** (top right) ends your session. Always sign out on a shared or public computer.
- If you are inactive for a while you may be asked to sign in again. This protects research data on unattended devices.

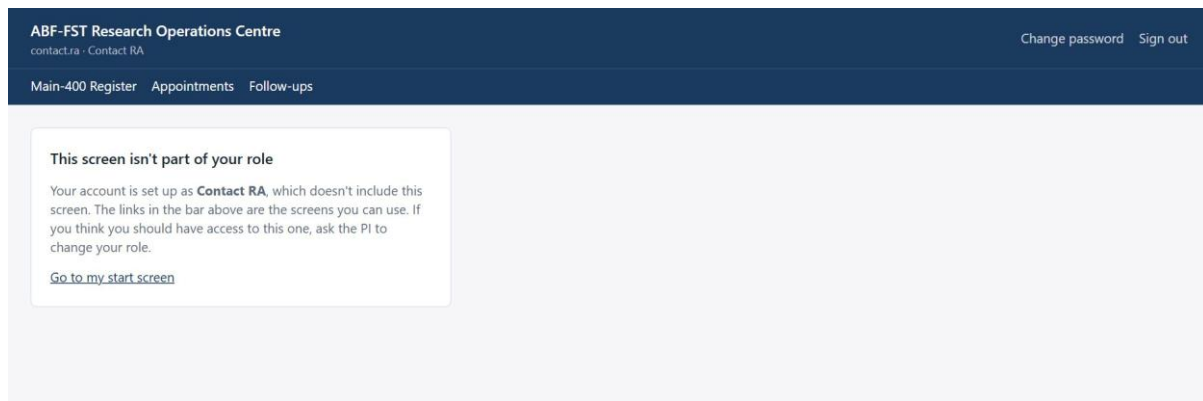


Figure 2. Opening a screen outside your role (for example from an old bookmark) shows this card instead of the screen.

Your screens

Screen	What you use it for
Executive, Sampling, Contact, QA, KII/Doc dashboards	Monitor progress against targets.
Reports	Analytics and charts for supervision meetings and progress reports.
Main-400 Register, Organisations	The sample: cases, bulk verification, new organisations.
Appointments, Follow-ups	Oversee contact and reminders.
Form PDFs	Completed forms for all three KoboToolbox forms.
QA Queue, QA Exceptions	Quality decisions and flags.
KII Register, Documents	Qualitative and documentary strands.
Reserve Activation	Replace dropped cases.
Cost	Fieldwork spend.
Audit Log	Who did what, when.
Export	All data downloads.

Changing your password

1. Select **Change password** in the top right corner.
2. Enter your **Current password**, then the **New password** twice, and select **Change password**.

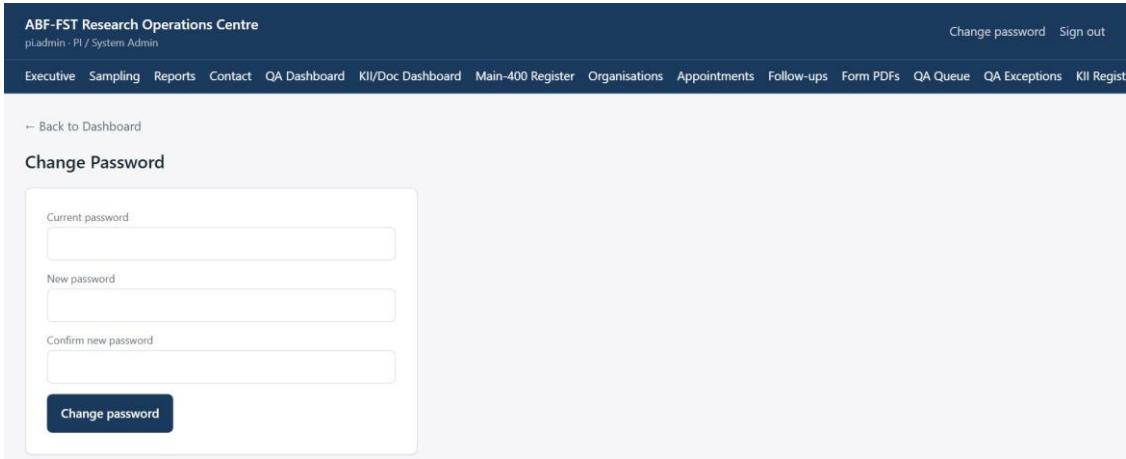


Figure 3. Change Password screen.

- 3. Use the new password next time you sign in. If you have forgotten your password, ask the PI to reset it.

3. Your routine

A suggested rhythm. Adjust it to the Field Coordinator's plan.

When	What to do
Daily	Executive Dashboard and Reports (last 7 days); QA Exceptions older than two days; Follow-ups backlog.
Weekly	Coverage and administration-mode balance in Reports; Reserve activations; Audit Log review; cost review; download the questionnaire workbook to monitor data quality.
When staff change	Create or deactivate accounts; reassign cases.
Before data lock (30 Nov 2026)	Close QA decisions and exceptions; final exports; store them securely.

4. Step-by-step tasks

4.1 Creating staff accounts

1. Open <https://research.agribizframework.com/django-admin/> and sign in with your PI account.
2. Select **Users** → **Add user**. Enter a username (e.g. firstname.lastname) and a strong temporary password; save.
3. Fill in the name and **email address**, choose the **Role** under **ABF-FST role**, and save.
4. Give the username and temporary password to the person separately (e.g. username by email, password by phone) and ask them to change it at first sign-in.
5. To remove access, untick **Active** and save. Do not delete users; their audit history must remain.

4.2 Reading the dashboards

Dashboards are for monitoring; nothing on them changes data. Figures refresh whenever the screen is opened.

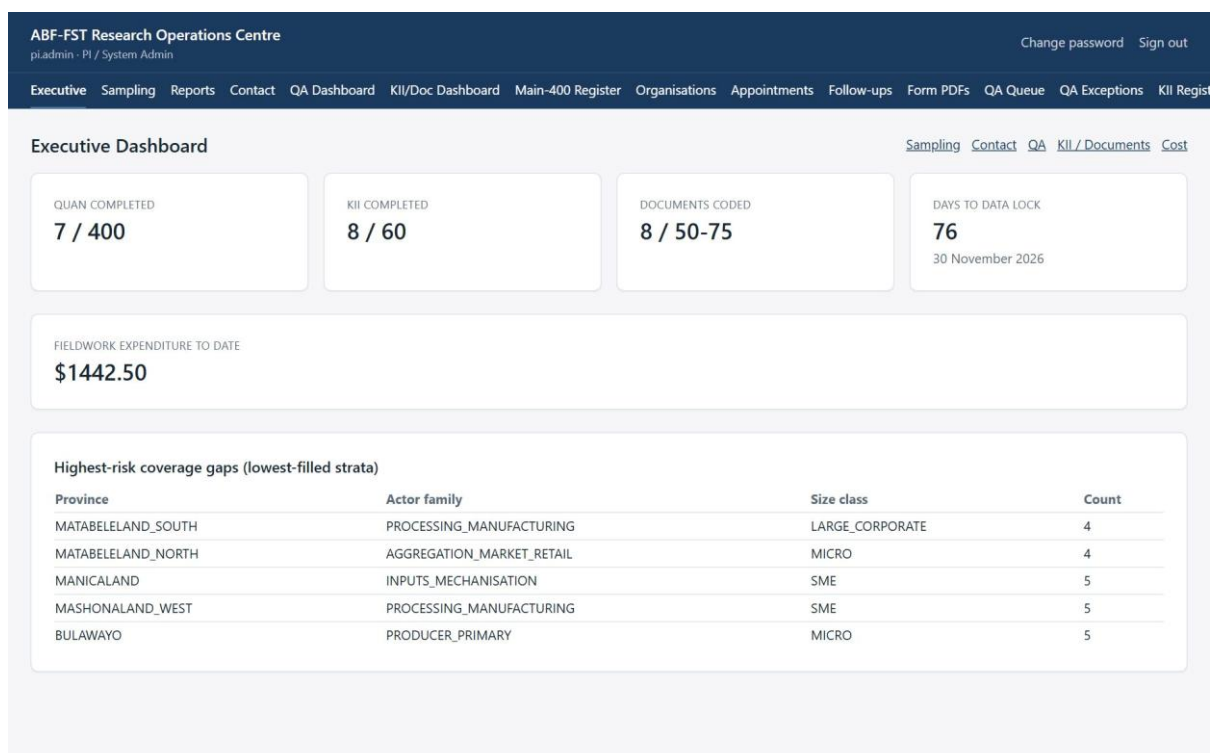


Figure 4. Executive Dashboard: completions against the 400 / 60 / 50–75 targets, days to data lock, spend, and the lowest-filled strata.

Dashboard	What it tells you	Use it to
Executive	QUAN completed out of 400, KII completed out of 60, documents coded against 50–75, days to the 30 November 2026 data lock, spend to date, lowest-filled strata.	See overall progress and where fieldwork attention is most needed.
Sampling	Main cases by province, verified/total by stratum, Reserve activations by reason.	Check the design stays balanced across strata.

Dashboard	What it tells you	Use it to
Contact	Organisations verified, eligible respondents identified, invitations sent and opened, upcoming appointments, refusals, unreachable cases.	Track outreach and spot stalled contact.
QA Dashboard	Submissions today and in total, the open QA queue, decisions recorded, completions by administration mode.	Keep the QA backlog under control.
KII/Doc Dashboard	KII completed against 60; KIIs by status; documents by type and QA status.	Track the qualitative and documentary strands.

Targets versus records

The registers hold more records than the targets (for example 90 KII records for 60 completed interviews). The surplus is reserve depth for non-response, not extra work.

4.3 Using Reports (analytics and charts)

1. Select **Reports** in the top bar.

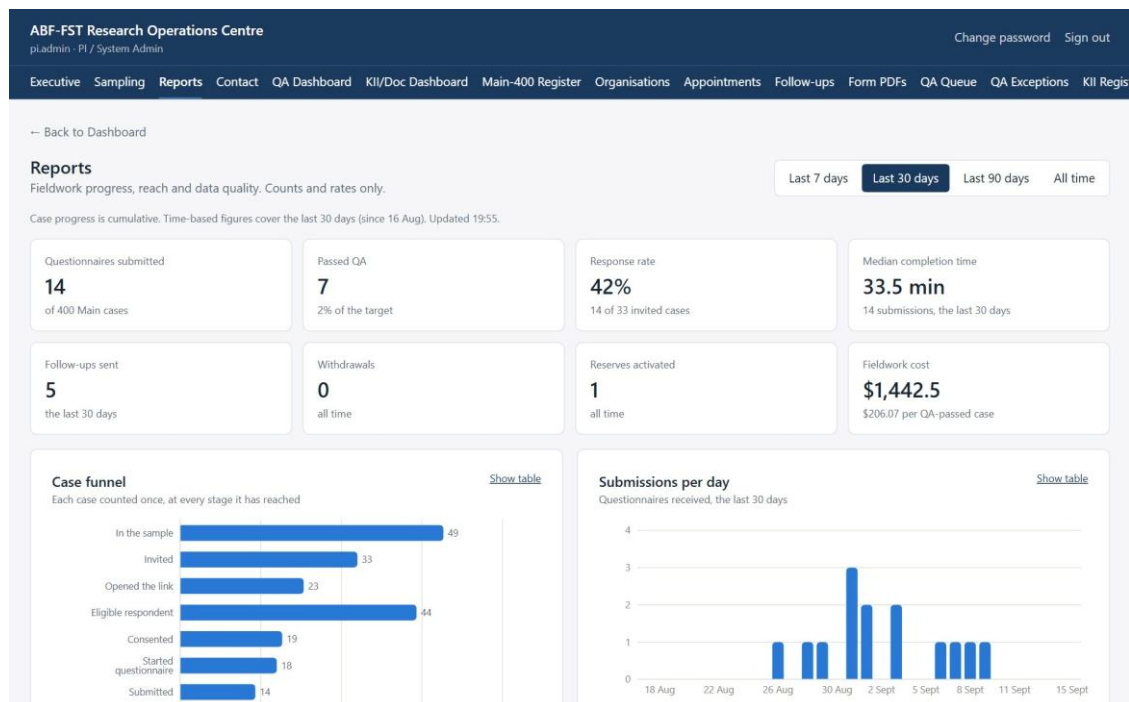


Figure 5. Reports: headline figures for the chosen period.

2. Choose the period with **Last 7 days**, **Last 30 days**, **Last 90 days** or **All time**. Case progress (the funnel and workflow) is always cumulative; time-based figures such as submissions per day follow the period.
3. Read the headline cards: questionnaires submitted, passed QA, response rate (submitted ÷ invited), median completion time, follow-ups sent, withdrawals, Reserves activated, and fieldwork cost per QA-passed case.

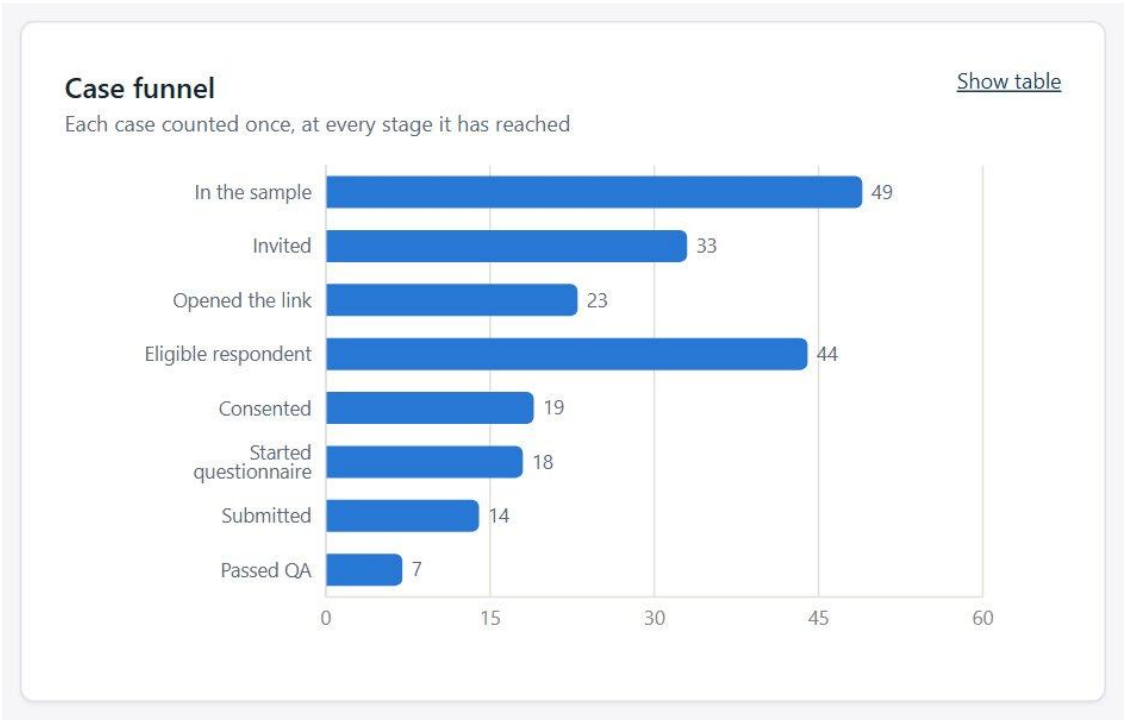


Figure 6. Case funnel: each case counted once at every stage it has reached.

4. Select **Show table** on any chart to see the exact numbers, for example to copy them into a progress report.

Case funnel

[Show chart](#)

Each case counted once, at every stage it has reached

Stage	Cases
In the sample	49
Invited	33
Opened the link	23
Eligible respondent	44
Consented	19
Started questionnaire	18
Submitted	14
Passed QA	7

Figure 7. The same chart as a table.

5. Use **Coverage** to see, by province, organisation type and size, what share of cases have been invited and have submitted. Short bars show where contact effort should go next.

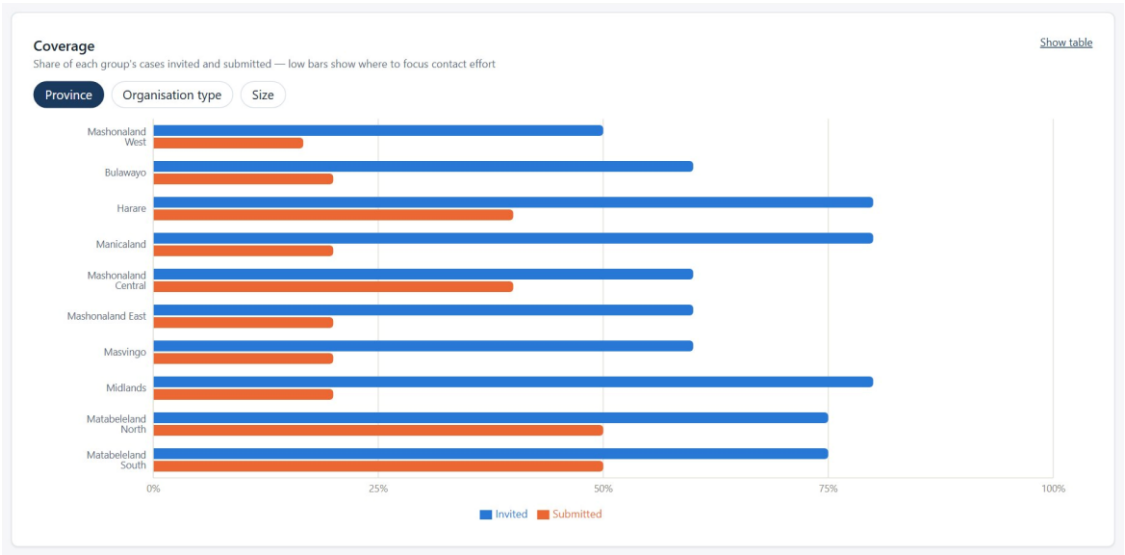


Figure 8. Coverage by group.

- 6. Check **How questionnaires were completed**. If one administration mode dominates (more than 70% once at least 10 questionnaires are in), the chart shows an imbalance alert so the team can review the mix.



Figure 9. Administration modes.

- 7. Review **Time to complete the questionnaire** and **QA outcomes**. Very short or very long completions are what the QA duration rules flag.

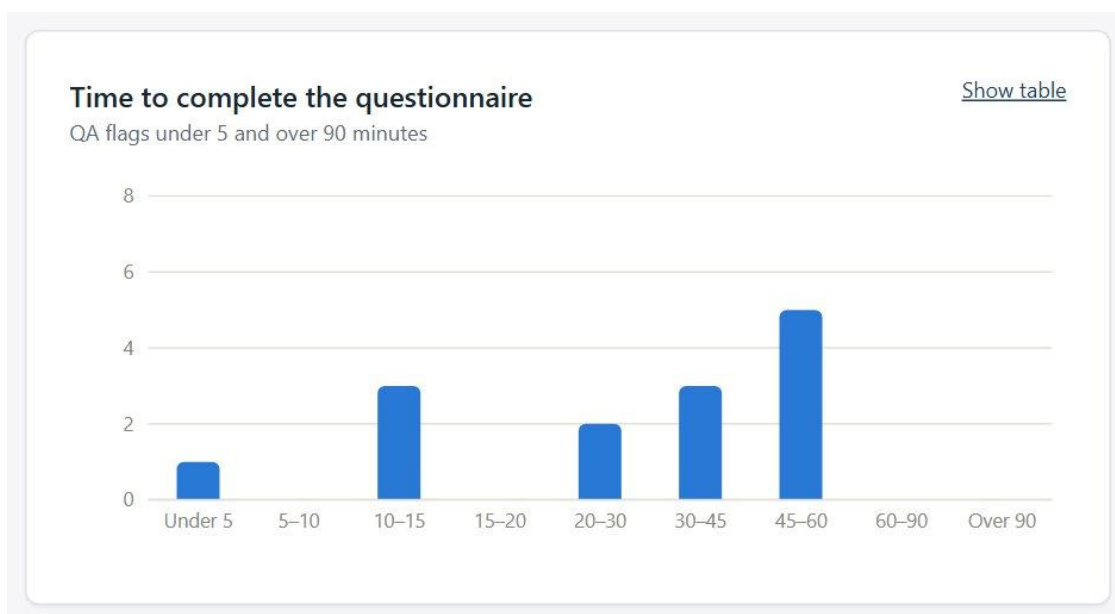


Figure 10. Completion-time distribution.

Reports show counts and rates only — never names or answers — so they are safe to discuss with supervisors.

4.4 Assigning cases to named Contact RAs

All 400 Main cases are currently assigned to the shared `contact_ra` account. Once individual Contact RA accounts exist, assign each case to its RA from the case page (**Assigned Contact RA**), then deactivate the shared account.

4.5 Pairing a Main case with its Reserve, and assigning a Contact RA

1. Open the Main case (**Main-400 Register** → **View**).
2. In **Assigned Contact RA**, choose the RA from the list. The change saves straight away and shows **Currently: <name>**. That RA now sees the case; other Contact RAs do not.

Assigned Contact RA

contact.ra Currently: contact.ra

Figure 11. Assigned Contact RA.

3. In **Matched Reserve case**, choose the Reserve. Only locked Reserves not already paired are offered, same-stratum ones first. A cross-stratum choice is allowed but flagged in the audit log.

Matched Reserve case

The Reserve that replaces this case if it drops out. Activating that Reserve later still requires an authorised reason and an evidence note.

SID-2026-000002 — Sable Creek Growers Cooperative Currently: SID-2026-000002 — Sable Creek Growers Cooperative

Figure 12. Matched Reserve case.

4.6 Moving cases through verification (bulk)

Every Main case must reach **S03 Eligible respondent identified** before it is invited, otherwise its status will not follow the respondent and no reminders are offered. Verification (S00 → S01 → S02 → S03) can be done for all cases at a step at once.

1. Open **Main-400 Register**.
2. In **Move cases through verification**, choose the step, for example **S00 Selected → S01 Verification required**. The button shows how many Main cases are at that step, e.g. **Move all 48**.

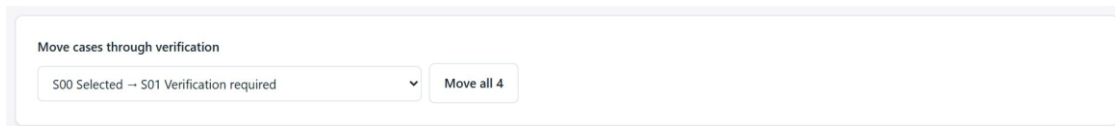


Figure 13. The bulk verification tool on the register.

3. Select the button and confirm. Each case is moved individually and each move is written to the audit log under your name.
4. Repeat for **S01 → S02** and **S02 → S03**.

Only verification is bulk

Statuses from S04 onwards follow real events (invitation sent, link opened, questionnaire submitted, QA decision) or an individual decision on the case page. They are never changed in bulk.

4.7 Downloading data

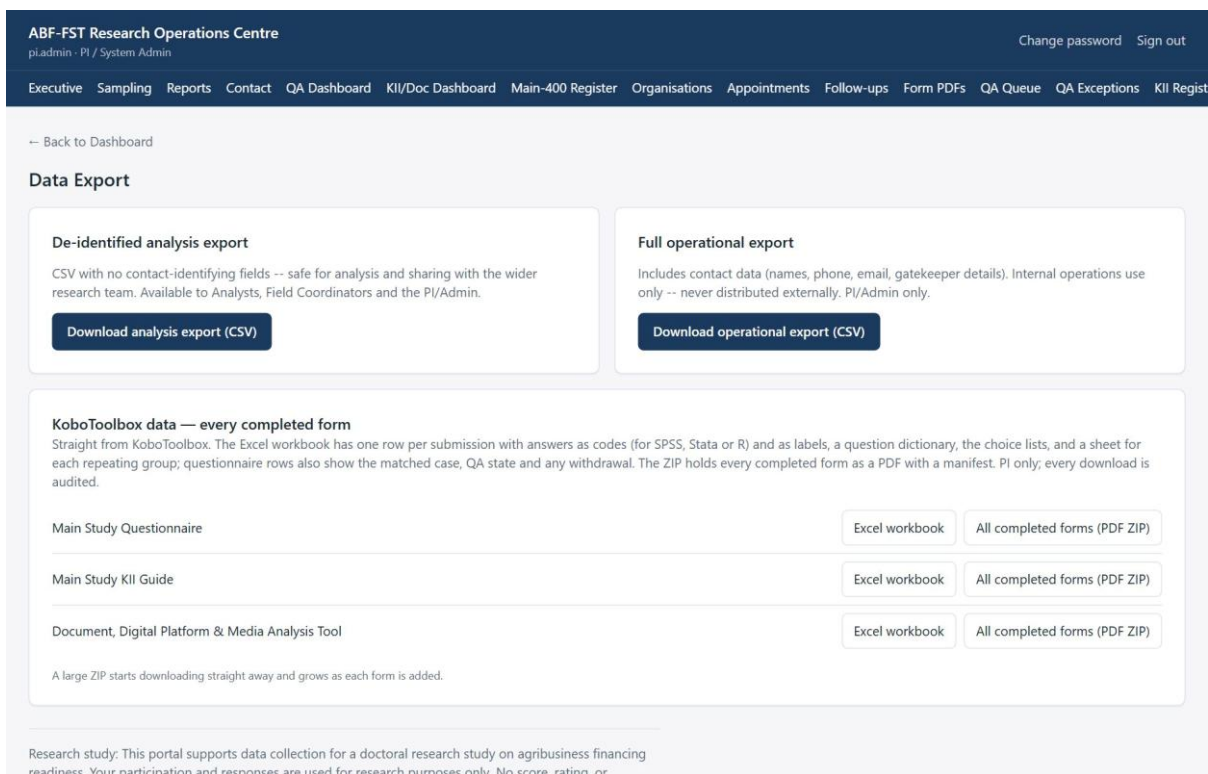


Figure 14. Data Export.

Download	Contains	Who
De-identified analysis export (CSV)	One row per questionnaire: <i>sampleid</i> , <i>masterid</i> , province, <i>actorfamily</i> , <i>valuechain</i> , <i>sizeclass</i> , <i>administrationmode</i> , <i>qastatus</i> , <i>submittedat</i> , <i>completionseconds</i> , <i>consentwithdrawn</i> . No names or contact details.	PI, Field Coordinator, Analyst
Full operational export (CSV)	The same plus organisation name, respondent name, phone, email and gatekeeper details. Internal operations only.	PI only
KoboToolbox data: Excel workbook	Every submission's answers for one form: <i>datacodes</i> (<i>codes for SPSS/Stata/R</i>), <i>datalabels</i> , a sheet per repeat group, the questions dictionary, the choices lists, and for the questionnaire the matched case, QA status, withdrawal flag and workflow status.	PI only
KoboToolbox data: All completed forms (PDF ZIP)	Every completed form as a PDF, with <i>manifest.csv</i> listing file, record, KoboToolbox id and submission time.	PI only

Getting all the data for cleaning and analysis

1. Select **Export**.
2. Under **KoboToolbox data — every completed form**, select **Excel workbook** for the **Main Study Questionnaire**. Repeat for the **Main Study KII Guide** and the **Document, Digital Platform & Media Analysis Tool**.
3. Select **All completed forms (PDF ZIP)** for each form you need as PDFs. A large ZIP starts at once and grows while it downloads — let it finish.
4. Open the workbook's **README** sheet first. Use *data_codes* for statistical software and *data_labels* for reading. *meta/rootUuid* identifies a submission across edits; *_parent_id* links repeat rows to their submission.
5. For analysis without identities, share only the **De-identified analysis export** and the workbook columns you have checked contain no names or contact details.

Handle raw data carefully

Workbooks and PDFs contain the answers themselves, and the KII Guide identifies people. Store them only on encrypted, access-controlled storage as the data management plan requires. Every download is recorded in the audit log.

4.8 Checking the audit log

1. Select **Audit Log**. Each row shows when, the action (e.g. *invitation.issued*, *consent.recorded*, *sampling.bulk_workflow_transition*, *kobo.data_exported*), the record, and the user.

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Change password Sign out

Executive Sampling Reports Contact QA Dashboard KII/Doc Dashboard Main-400 Register Organisations Appointments Follow-ups Form PDFs QA Queue QA Exceptions KII Register

← Back to Dashboard

Audit Log

When	Action	Object	User
9/15/2026, 7:36:40 PM	invitation.issued	InvitationToken:40	contact.ra
9/15/2026, 7:34:06 PM	invitation.issued	InvitationToken:39	contact.ra
9/15/2026, 7:30:55 PM	consent.recorded	ConsentRecord:38	system
9/15/2026, 7:30:55 PM	eligibility.checked	Respondent:49	system
9/15/2026, 7:30:27 PM	consent.recorded	ConsentRecord:37	system
9/15/2026, 7:30:22 PM	eligibility.checked	Respondent:48	system
9/15/2026, 7:30:08 PM	invitation.issued	InvitationToken:38	system
9/15/2026, 7:30:08 PM	invitation.issued	InvitationToken:37	system
9/15/2026, 7:29:09 PM	consent.recorded	ConsentRecord:36	system
9/15/2026, 7:29:09 PM	eligibility.checked	Respondent:47	system
9/15/2026, 7:27:54 PM	consent.recorded	ConsentRecord:35	system
9/15/2026, 7:27:48 PM	eligibility.checked	Respondent:46	system
9/15/2026, 7:27:29 PM	invitation.issued	InvitationToken:36	system
9/15/2026, 7:27:29 PM	invitation.issued	InvitationToken:35	system
9/15/2026, 7:26:29 PM	consent.recorded	ConsentRecord:34	system
9/15/2026, 7:26:25 PM	eligibility.checked	Respondent:45	system

Figure 15. Audit Log, newest first.

- Page through with **Previous** and **Next**. Actions taken by scheduled jobs or by respondents themselves show **system**.

4.9 Recording a withdrawal

A participant may withdraw at any time, for any reason, without giving one.

- Stop contacting the person immediately.
- On the case page, in **Record a withdrawal**, choose **How they told us — By phone or in person**, or **In writing (WhatsApp, email, letter) —** and type the reason or their own words.

Record a withdrawal

Use when the participant asks to withdraw. Their link stops working, reminders stop, and their phone, WhatsApp, email and gatekeeper contact are erased. This can't be undone.

How they told us

By phone or in person

Reason or their words

Record withdrawal

Figure 16. Record a withdrawal.

- Select **Record withdrawal** and confirm.

In one step the portal records the withdrawal, stops the invitation link and all reminders, moves the case to **S12 Refused** where allowed, erases the phone, WhatsApp, email and gatekeeper contact, and flags the case as `consent_withdrawn` in every export. This cannot be undone.

Answers already submitted

Withdrawal does not delete a questionnaire already in KoboToolbox. The PI decides how submitted data from a withdrawn participant is handled in analysis; the export flag makes such cases easy to find.

4.10 Activating a Reserve case

A Reserve replaces its Main case only after the Main case reaches a drop state (S12 Refused, S13 Nonresponse, S14 Ineligible or S15 Duplicate/inactive) and there is evidence.

1. Select **Reserve Activation**. Every locked Reserve is listed with a search box.

The screenshot shows the 'Reserve Activation' page. At the top, there's a navigation bar with 'ABF-FST Research Operations Centre' and 'pladmin - PI / System Admin'. Below this is a menu bar with various options like 'Executive', 'Sampling', 'Reports', etc. The main content area has a 'Back to Dashboard' link and a search bar. Under the search bar, there's a section titled 'Reserve Activation'. It lists two reserves: 'Sable Creek Growers Cooperative' and 'Tamarind Flats Grain Millers (Pvt) Ltd'. Each reserve has a dropdown menu for 'Select authorised reason' and a text area for 'Evidence note (required)'. An 'Activate this reserve' button is located below the evidence note for each reserve.

Figure 17. Reserve Activation.

2. Find the Reserve matched to the dropped Main case (the Main case page shows the pairing).
3. Choose the authorised reason: **Ineligible, Inactive, Duplicate, Refusal** or **Nonresponse exhausted**. There is deliberately no "other".
4. Write the **Evidence note (required)**, e.g. "MD declined by phone 12 Sep, logged in contact timeline".
5. Select **Activate this reserve**. The Reserve becomes invitable and is worked like any Main case, starting with verification.

4.11 Reviewing questionnaires in the QA Queue

1. Select **QA Queue**. Each submission shows the Sample ID, when it was submitted, the administration mode, the completion time in minutes and its QA status (PENDING or QUERY).

Figure 18. QUAN QA Queue with the KoboToolbox sync panel.

- Open the completed form to check the answers: **Form PDFs → Download PDF**, or the **Completed questionnaire** panel on the case page.
- Check it against the QA rules (table below) and any open QA exception for that case.
- Write a **Note (required)** explaining your decision.
- Select **Accept** (moves the case to S10 QA passed), **Re-query** (S09 QA query — follow up with the respondent or the RA who administered it) or **Reject** (not usable).

Rule	Setting	Effect
Required answers missing	65 required fields from the live questionnaire	Hard stop: raises an exception; cannot pass without a human decision and note.
Too quick	Completed in under 5 minutes (300 s)	Soft flag for review.
Too slow	Completed in over 90 minutes (5400 s)	Soft flag for review.
Possible duplicate	Another submission for the same organisation within 24 hours	Soft flag for review.

Nothing passes automatically

Even a submission with no flags needs a person to select Accept. Every decision and its note is audited.

Pulling new submissions now

Submissions arrive within seconds (KoboToolbox notifies the portal) and a full check runs every 15 minutes between 06:00 and 22:00 and hourly overnight. To check immediately, select **Sync now** in **KoboToolbox sync**; the panel shows the last run, how many were pulled and how many were new or updated. An edited submission returns to the queue for review.

4.12 Working QA exceptions

1. Select **QA Exceptions**. Each card shows the rule that fired (for example `hard_stop_missing_required_fields` or `min_plausible_duration_seconds`), the Sample ID, when it was raised and its status. Oldest first.

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qa.ra · QUAN/Kobo QA RA

Change password Sign out

QA Dashboard Form PDFs QA Queue QA Exceptions

← Back to QA Queue

QA Exception Queue
Automated QA flags awaiting someone. Oldest first.

☐ Only mine ☐ Show closed

OPEN ON THIS PAGE
1

IN PROGRESS
2

OLDEST HERE
today

min_plausible_duration_seconds
QUAN submission SID-2026-000057 · raised 9/15/2026

Unassigned

What was done about it? (required to close)

Resolved Not a real problem

A note is required before closing — a closure nobody explained looks the same as one nobody looked at.

hard_stop_missing_required_fields
QUAN submission SID-2026-000065 · raised 9/15/2026

qa.ra with qa.ra

Figure 19. QA Exception Queue.

2. Tick **Only mine** to see exceptions assigned to you; tick **Show closed** to include resolved ones.
3. Use **Assign to** to take ownership (or give it to a colleague). The status becomes **In progress**.
4. Investigate: open the form PDF, check the case timeline, contact the respondent if needed.
5. Type **What was done about it?** and select **Resolved**, or **Not a real problem** if the flag was a false alarm. A note is always required.

4.13 Downloading or emailing completed forms (Form PDFs)

1. Select **Form PDFs**. You see the completed questionnaire, KII Guide and document forms from KoboToolbox, newest first, 20 per page.

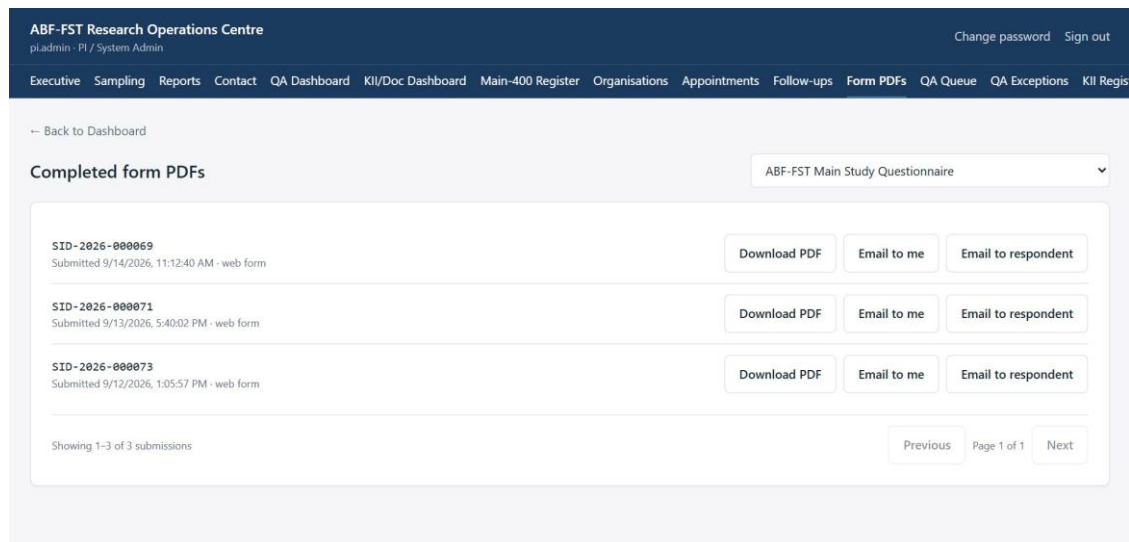


Figure 20. Completed form PDFs.

2. Select **Download PDF** to save a readable copy: sections, questions, the chosen answers as words (not codes) and repeated groups.
3. Select **Email to me** to send the PDF to the email address on your account.
4. For the questionnaire only, select **Email to respondent** to send the respondent a copy of their own answers at the email address recorded on the case (only while their consent stands). You are asked to confirm first. Every email is audited with the address masked.

The same PDF is available from the record itself: the case page (questionnaire), the KII page (KII Guide) or the document page (coding form).

4.14 KoboToolbox: rotating credentials and changing forms

1. Change the KoboToolbox password, then create a new API token (**Account settings → Security**).
2. On the server run `sudo bash /srv/agribiz-drp/deploy/configure-kobo.sh` and paste the new token when asked.
3. In **QA Queue**, select **Sync now** and check the run succeeds.
4. When editing a form, keep the identifier fields unchanged (see System Manual 9.2), test with a test invitation, and delete the test submission.

4.15 Before the first live invitation

- Collect respondent phone numbers on the case pages (many Main cases have none yet).
- Rotate the KoboToolbox password and API token.
- Add the Gmail App Password with `configure-email.sh` so **Email** buttons work.
- Complete the one-time Google Drive sign-in for offsite backups and store the encryption key in a password manager.
- Create named accounts for each RA and reassign cases.
- Run one user-acceptance invitation end to end on a real phone.

5. Rules you must follow

- Download raw KoboToolbox data only to encrypted, access-controlled storage; every download is audited.
- Share only the de-identified analysis export beyond the core team.
- Treat everything in the portal as **confidential research data**. Do not screenshot, copy, print or forward names, phone numbers, email addresses or answers except as your role requires.
- Never share your username or password, and never sign in for someone else.
- Use the respondent's contact details **only** to manage their participation in this study (invitations, reminders, appointments).
- Never tell a respondent, lender or anyone else that answers affect financing. The study generates **no score, rating or financing decision**.
- If a respondent asks to withdraw, stop contacting them and tell the Field Coordinator or PI the same day so the withdrawal is recorded.
- Report a lost device, a suspected account compromise, or data sent to the wrong person to the PI immediately.

6. Troubleshooting

Situation	Likely cause	What to do
Email buttons missing or failing	Outgoing email not configured, or the Gmail App Password revoked.	Run <code>configure-email.sh</code> on the server.
Workbook shows NOT/NPORTAL in <code>portalqa</code> status	A submission that was not matched to a case (e.g. a test or a direct public-link submission).	Check it in KoboToolbox; exclude or delete test submissions.
"This screen isn't part of your role"	The screen belongs to another role (often an old bookmark or shared link).	Select Go to my start screen. If you need that screen, ask the PI about your role.
"Too many sign-in attempts from this network"	Sign-in is rate-limited per network; an office shares one address.	Wait a minute and try again. A wrong password says so explicitly.
A register shows fewer rows than expected	Registers show 20 rows per page; a Contact RA sees only assigned cases.	Use Next, or search. Ask the Field Coordinator to assign the case.
A button is greyed out	A required step is missing (a note, an authenticity decision, a selection).	Read the message beside the button; complete the missing step first.
"KoboToolbox couldn't be reached"	KoboToolbox is slow or the connection token has changed.	Try again in a few minutes. If it persists, tell the PI.
A page keeps loading	A slow or dropped connection.	Refresh the page. Your saved work is not lost; unsaved typing may be.

7. Quick reference

Sign in	https://research.agribizframework.com/admin/login
You start on	Executive Dashboard
Account admin	https://research.agribizframework.com/django-admin/
KoboToolbox	https://kf.kobotoolbox.org
Your exports	Export → KoboToolbox data (Excel workbook, PDF ZIP)
Help	Field Coordinator; PI: Happyson Saina, 0773943709, abffst.research.cut@gmail.com